

Peter James Aungle

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EDUCATION

Harvard University Cambridge, MA
PhD, Psychology May 2026
Dissertation: "Embodied models of health: mind-body unity and the psychological determinants of physical health"
Committee: Ellen Langer (primary advisor, committee chair), Leah Somerville, Fiery Cushman

University of California at Berkeley Berkeley, CA
BA, Psychology May 2009

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

oTree Open Source Research Foundation June 2026 – May 2027
Postdoctoral Research Fellow

Harvard University, Department of Psychology June 2026 – May 2027
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Langer Lab

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Psychological influences on physical health; how mindsets shape performance and health outcomes; improving health and performance by identifying and intervening on limiting beliefs

PUBLICATIONS

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2023). Physical healing as a function of perceived time. *Scientific Reports*, 13(1), 22432. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-50009-3>

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2024). The borderline effect for diabetes: when no difference makes a difference. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 15. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1333248>

Langer, E., & Aungle, P. (2024). How much do our thoughts shape our health? *Scientific American*. <https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/how-much-do-our-thoughts-shape-our-health/>

Aungle, P., Holmes, N., & Chen, D. (2026). Beyond Statistical Myopia: Replying to a Misguided Critique of Mind-Body Research. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/mgw73_v1

Aungle, P. & Pagnini, F. (under review). *Reconsidering the Exclusion of Langerian Mindfulness: A Commentary on Chems-Maarif et al. (2025)*. [Mindfulness]

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Aungle, P. & Langer, E. (in prep). *Embodied models of health: A theoretical framework of mind-body unity*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ubtxw_v1

Aungle, P., Matta, P.M., Loecher, M., Chen, D. (*in prep*). *A computational framework of mind-body unity: formalizing embodied models of health*.

Aungle, P., Zhang, Y., Nagarathinam, V., Paradis, J., Chen, D. (*in prep*). *The surprising power of sadness in workplace conflict: when vulnerability outperforms dominance*.

Aungle, P., Bross, J., & Langer, E. (*in prep*). *Manipulating temporal expectations to accelerate healing after cataract surgery: a randomized controlled trial*.

Mehmood, S., Bakhtawar, A., Brown, H., Aungle, P., Reinhart, E., Chen, D. (*in prep*). *Transmitting Tranquility: The Impact of Teacher Mindfulness and CBT on Student Achievement*.

Aydinian, T., Barzilai, D., Aungle, P., Langer, E. (*in prep*). *Mindfulness, Mind-Body Unity, and Longevity*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Harvard University, Psychology Department

Teaching Fellow

Spring 2026

Course: "Introduction to Social Psychology" (professor of record: Ashwini Ashokkumar)

Average student rating: 4.82/5.0

- Led 1 section of 15 students

Head Teaching Fellow

Fall 2025

Course: "Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective," (professor of record: Ellen Langer)

Average student rating: 4.80/5.0

- Collaborated with Professor Langer to create the course syllabus, developed all section materials, taught all 5 sections for the course of approximately 80 students in total

Head Teaching Fellow

Fall 2023

Course: "Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective," (professor of record: Ellen Langer)

Average student rating: 4.95/5.0

- Collaborated with Professor Langer to create the course syllabus, developed all section materials, led weekly meeting with teaching staff, taught 2 sections

Instructor

2023-2024

Course: "Instructional Styles in Psychology" (sole instructor)

Average student rating: 4.5/5.0

- Designed and taught a required pedagogy course for new graduate student teaching fellows in the psychology department

Psychology Department Pedagogy Fellow

2023-2024

- Provided teaching consultations to teaching fellows in the department, attended weekly workshops at the Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, completed a capstone project to help future psychology pedagogy fellows develop their courses

Teaching Fellow

Spring 2023

Course: "Introduction to Social Psychology" (professor of record: Fiery Cushman)

Average student rating: 4.52/5.0

- Led 2 sections of approximately 20 students each

Teaching Fellow

Fall 2021 & 2022

Course: "Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective," (professor of record: Ellen Langer)

Average student rating: 4.32/5.0

- Led 2 sections in 2021 and 3 sections in 2022 of approximately 15 students each

Teaching Fellow

Spring 2022

Course: "Introduction to Psychological Science" (professor of record: Jason Mitchell)

Average student rating: 4.38/5.0

- Led 2 sections of approximately 15 students each

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

New York, NY

Research Assistant

2018 – 2019

Advisor: Janet Metcalfe

Project: Learning from errors

- Created problem sets for study participants designed to maximize what students learn from errors while preparing for the New York State Math Regents exam
- Consulted on the experimental design, particularly in terms of how to explain common errors and relate to the correct problem-solving process

University of California at Berkeley

Berkeley, CA

Research Assistant

2006 – 2009

Advisor: Darlene Francis

Projects: The development of risk preferences in rat pups; the effects of rank in social hierarchies on behavior in a competitive task

- Helped run a study that tested the effects of prenatal stress on risk-taking behavior in rat pups. We found that prenatally stressed pups were significantly more likely to take physically threatening risks than healthy controls.
- Designed and ran a study to test the effect of within-group social rank on behavior in a competitive task. We paired unfamiliar rats matched for physical signs of dominance but with different within-group social ranks to test whether social rank predicted performance. Higher ranked rats tended to outperform their otherwise comparable peers, but the difference wasn't significant.

University of California at Berkeley

Berkeley, CA

Research Assistant

2007 – 2008

Advisor: Jack Glaser

Project: Implicit motivation to control prejudice

- Ran participants for an experimental study examining the implicit motivation to control prejudice in a “Shooter Task”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Private Tutor, Smarter Test Prep, 2011 – 2021

Independent Options Trader & Investment Analyst, 2014 – 2016

Sales Analyst, Aflac Insurance Company, 2010 – 2011

Business Development Services Analyst, Goldman Sachs Asset Management, 2009 – 2010

Communications Analyst, Hattaway Communications, 2008 – 2009

Press Advance Lead, National Advance Team, Hillary Clinton for President, 2007 – 2008

REFERENCES

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Professor of Economics
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